

Sharing across sectors and closing a negotiation

Day 5 · Session 1 | Both sectors | Shared resource

The second half of this document is designed to be useful long after the workshop. Keep it — the closing sequence is the part of this week you will use most often.

Part 1 — Report-Back and Debrief Worksheet

If you are your sector's spokesperson

You have eight minutes. Prepare against these five points — the other sector has not seen your case at all, so start with the dispute itself.

Point	Your notes
The dispute, in two sentences	
What we agreed	
What we did NOT agree, and why	
Our outcome scenario (A-E), honestly	
The one technique that made the most difference	

Listening to the other sector

You are about to hear a negotiation from a sector that is not yours. Note as you listen:

Question	Your answer
What was familiar — the same structure or pressure as ours?	
What was genuinely different?	
What did they do that we could use?	

The difficult-moments debrief

On Thursday afternoon you made a plan for difficult moments — anger and emotion, five difficult behaviours, and the problem of face. Then you negotiated. This is where you find out what survived.

"I completely forgot I had a plan" is the most common honest answer in this debrief, and one of the most useful. Plans that survive pressure are single sentences decided in advance; elaborate plans do not fire.

Question	Your answer
The most difficult moment — and what triggered it	
What I did in the first ten seconds	
Would I do the same again?	
Did anyone need to move without losing face? What was offered to help them?	
The strategic choice I am least sure about	

Question 1
Your two improvement priorities from Day 3 — did you do them? What happened?

Part 2 — Take-Away Reference Card

Keep this. It is the most reusable page produced this week.

Closing a negotiation: the six-step sequence

In order — most negotiators do only two or three	Detail
1. Signal it	Say plainly that you are moving to close. Negotiations that drift into a close produce vague agreements.
2. Summarize what is agreed	Out loud, in their language as well as yours. Surfaces misunderstandings while there is still time.
3. Name what is NOT agreed	And what happens to it. The step people most want to skip — and skipping it is how an item returns as a grievance.

In order — most negotiators do only two or three	Detail
4. Fix the specifics	Who, what, how much, by when, and from which budget. An agreement without a budget line is an intention.
5. Agree the record	How it will be written and by whom. The party that drafts influences the meaning.
6. Agree a review point	A date to check it is actually happening. This single step does most to prevent an agreement quietly dying.

The last ten minutes

Do	Don't
Slow down — relief makes careful people careless Read it back and ask directly: have I got that right? Let the other side state their own win in their own words Confirm what each side will tell the people not in the room	Introduce a new demand once closing has started Accept "we'll sort out the details later" on anything costing money Let relief carry you past an ambiguity you noticed Leave without agreeing who writes it down

Handling difficult moments — the short version

When emotion arrives	Detail
Slow down	Lower your pace and volume rather than matching theirs.
Acknowledge first	Address the feeling before the substance.
Separate person from problem	Say it out loud if you need to.
Ask for a break	Five minutes is a technique, not a retreat.

If they...	Detail
Repeat the same demand	Say what you have heard, then ask what would need to change for movement to be possible.
Make it personal	Name it once, calmly, then return to the issue.
Threaten to walk out	Do not bid against it. Acknowledge, restate the cost of no agreement, wait.
Add a demand late	Name it as new. Decide openly whether the agenda reopens.
Go silent	Invite them in. Silence often holds the objection that surfaces later.

Helping someone move without losing face

Concern about standing and credibility can prevent movement even when the substance becomes acceptable. Explore how a party could explain a change honestly to its constituency.

What makes movement possible	Detail
New information	A genuinely new fact justifies a changed position where pressure cannot.
A reciprocal move	However small — so nobody moves alone.
Framing language	Words that make the shift a decision rather than a surrender. Supply them deliberately.
A private conversation first	Many public agreements are reached before the public moment.

Your own note

Question 2

One thing from this week you intend to use in the next negotiation you are part of — and when that negotiation is likely to be: